

the 1990s, the number of people in the UK who are employed in the public sector has increased by 1.5 million (from 2.5 million in 1980 to 4 million in 1999) and the number of people in the private sector has increased by 1.5 million (from 2.5 million in 1980 to 4 million in 1999) (Department of Health 2000).

There is a growing emphasis on the need to improve the quality of care in the public sector. This has led to a number of initiatives, including the introduction of the National Patient Safety Agency (NPSA) in 1999, the establishment of the National Institute for Clinical Excellence (NICE) in 2001, and the introduction of the Health Care Act 2001. These initiatives have all aimed to improve the quality of care in the public sector, but they have also led to a number of challenges for the public sector.

One of the main challenges for the public sector is the need to improve the quality of care while at the same time reducing costs. This is a difficult task, as the public sector is often faced with the need to provide high-quality care at a lower cost than the private sector. This has led to a number of initiatives, including the introduction of the Health Care Act 2001, which aimed to improve the quality of care in the public sector while at the same time reducing costs.

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